

Homework 12, Week 14

Activity 2

ACTIVITY 2

Read the following sentences carefully, examine their modes of reasoning and comment on whether the reasoning is sound. If not, discuss in pairs how you would improve it.

1. Noble gases are stable. Neon is a noble gas. Therefore, neon is stable.
2. Monocot flower parts are in multiples of three. Apple flowers have five petals. Therefore, apple trees are not monocots.
3. All wasps have stingers. That is a wasp, so it has a stinger.
4. Be careful of that dog—it might bite you.
5. All of the swans we have seen are white. Therefore, all swans are white.
6. Exercising relieves stress. Exercising keeps you in shape. Exercising lowers the risk of heart disease. Everyone should exercise at least three times a week to maintain a healthy lifestyle.
7. All the tigers observed in a particular region have black stripes on orange fur. Therefore all tigers native to this region have black stripes on orange fur.
8. When chimpanzees are exposed to rage, they tend to become violent. Humans are similar to chimpanzees, and therefore, they tend to get violent when exposed to rage.

9. Every time you get a call from some unknown number, you find a telemarketer on the other side of the line. It makes you conclude that if you receive an unknown call, it is most likely to be a telemarketer.
10. To win a race, one must compete. Tim competed, so Tim will win the race.

1. Deduction and sound.
2. Deduction and sound.
3. Deduction and sound.
4. Induction and sound.
5. Induction and unsound. The author needs to take more scientific evidences or make the conclusion more accurate with the word "might".
6. Induction and sound.

7. Induction and unsound. The author should observe more tigers as example to make the induction more reasonable or make the conclusion more accurate by removing "all".
 8. Induction and unsound. The author should find more similar points between chimpanzees and human to improve the credibility.
 9. Induction and sound.
 10. Deduction but unsound. The condition is necessary but not sufficient. The right statement is "Tim win the race, so Tim competed."
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Essay I

The Web Shatters Focus, Rewires Brains

Nicholas Carr

Paragraph 1

What kind of brain is the Web giving us? That question will no doubt be the subject of a great deal of research in the years ahead. Already, though, there is much we know or can surmise—and the news is quite disturbing. Dozens of studies by psychologists, neurobiologists, and educators point to the same conclusion: When we go online, we enter an environment that promotes cursory reading, hurried and distracted thinking, and superficial learning. Even as the Internet grants us easy access to vast amounts of information, it is turning us into shallower thinkers, literally changing the structure of our brain. ***(Introduce the claim that the Web makes our thinking shallower and gradually changing our structure of our brain even if it is useful in many aspects)***

Paragraph 2

Back in the 1980s, when schools began investing heavily in computers, there was much enthusiasm about the apparent advantages of digital documents over paper ones. Many educators were convinced that introducing hyperlinks into text displayed on monitors would be a boon to learning. Hypertext would strengthen critical thinking, the argument went, by enabling students to switch easily between different viewpoints. Freed from the lockstep reading demanded by printed pages, readers would make all sorts of new intellectual connections between diverse works. The hyperlink would be a technology of liberation. ***(State the facts in the 1980s that many educators advocated the computers in education and uttered the advantages of the Web)***

Paragraph 3

By the end of the decade, the enthusiasm was turning to skepticism. Research was painting a fuller, very different picture of the cognitive effects of hypertext. Navigating linked documents, it turned out, entails a lot of mental calisthenics—evaluating hyperlinks, deciding whether to click, adjusting to different formats—that are extraneous to the process of reading. Because it disrupts concentration, such activity weakens comprehension. A 1989 study showed that readers tended just to click around aimlessly when reading something that included hypertext links to other selected pieces of information. A 1990 experiment revealed that some “could not remember what they had and had not read.” ***(State that in the end of 1980s many people became skeptical to the effects of the Web to the readers)***

Paragraph 4

Even though the World Wide Web has made hypertext ubiquitous and presumably less startling and unfamiliar, the cognitive problems remain. Research continues to show that people who read linear text comprehend more, remember more, and learn more than those who read text peppered with links.... ***(Further show that the online reading make the concentration weak by the research)***

Paragraph 5

A 2007 scholarly review of hypertext experiments concluded that jumping between digital documents impedes understanding. And if links are bad for concentration and comprehension, it shouldn't be surprising that more recent research suggests that links surrounded by images, videos, and advertisements could be even worse. ***(Analyze the digital link or documents and the things surrounding it impedes understanding)***

Paragraph 6

In a study published in the journal *Media Psychology*, researchers had more than 100 volunteers watch a presentation about the country of Mali, played through a Web browser. Some watched a text-only version. Others watched a version that incorporated video. Afterward, the subjects were quizzed on the material. Compared to the multimedia viewers, the text-only viewers answered significantly more questions correctly; they also found the presentation to be more interesting, more educational, more understandable, and more enjoyable. ***(Through the experiment to show that reading only text makes more concentrative than reading with multimedia like videos)***

Paragraph 7

The depth of our intelligence hinges on our ability to transfer information from working memory, the scratch pad of consciousness, to long-term memory, the mind's filing system. When facts and experiences enter our long-term memory, we are able to weave them into the complex

ideas that give richness to our thought. But the passage from working memory to long-term memory also forms a bottleneck in our brain. Whereas long-term memory has an almost unlimited capacity, working memory can hold only a relatively small amount of information at a time. And that short-term storage is fragile. A break in our attention can sweep its contents from our mind. ***(Deeply introduce the essence of the depth of our intelligence in our brain)***

Paragraph 8

Imagine filling a bathtub with a **thimble**; that's the challenge involved in moving information from working memory into long-term memory. When we read a book, the information **faucet** provides a steady **drip**, which we can control by varying the pace of our reading. Through our single-minded concentration on the text, we can transfer much of the information, thimbleful by thimbleful, into long-term memory and forge the rich associations essential to the creation of knowledge and wisdom. ***(Use the upper theory and analogy to interpret the concentrative process of reading books)***

Paragraph 9

On the Net, we face many information faucets, all going full blast. Our little thimble overflows as we rush from tap to tap. We transfer only a small jumble of drops from different faucets, not a continuous, coherent stream. ***(Use the analogy of drips and faucet to interpret why we can not concentrate on reading on the net)***

Paragraph 10

Psychologists refer to the information flowing into our working memory as our cognitive load. When the load exceeds our mind's ability to process and store it, we're unable to retain the information or to draw connections with other memories. We can't translate the new material into conceptual knowledge. Our ability to learn suffers, and our understanding remains weak. That's why the extensive brain activity that Small discovered in Web searchers may be more a cause for concern than for celebration. It points to cognitive overload. ***(Summarize the reason why the extensive brain activity on the net lead to difficult concentration)***

Paragraph 11

The Internet is an interruption system. It seizes our attention only to **scramble** it. There's the problem of hypertext and the many different kinds of media coming at us simultaneously. There's also the fact that numerous studies—including one that tracked eye movement, one that surveyed people, and even one that examined the habits displayed by users of two academic databases—show that we start to read faster and less thoroughly as soon as we go online. Plus, the Internet has a hundred ways of distracting us from our onscreen reading. Most email applications check automatically for new messages every five or 10 minutes, and people

routinely click the Check for New Mail button even more frequently. Office workers often glance at their inbox 30 to 40 times an hour. Since each glance breaks our concentration and burdens our working memory, the cognitive penalty can be severe. ***(Explain the Internet interrupts our attention in many aspects and takes some examples)***

Paragraph 12

The penalty is **amplified** by what brain scientists call switching costs. Every time we shift our attention, the brain has to reorient itself, further taxing our mental resources. Many studies have shown that switching between just two tasks can add substantially to our cognitive load, impeding our thinking and increasing the likelihood that we'll overlook or misinterpret important information. On the Internet, where we generally **juggle** several tasks, the switching costs pile ever higher. ***(Explain the term, penalty, in the field of reading on the Internet)***

Paragraph 13

The Net's ability to monitor events and send out messages and notifications automatically is, of course, one of its great strengths as a communication technology. We rely on that capability to personalize the workings of the system, to program the vast database to respond to our particular needs, interests, and desires. We want to be interrupted, because each interruption—email, tweet, instant message, RSS headline—brings us a valuable piece of information. To turn off these alerts is to risk feeling out of touch or even socially isolated. The stream of new information also plays to our natural tendency to overemphasize the immediate. We crave the new even when we know it's trivial. ***(State the advantage of the Net that sent much messages and notifications in time and socialize us)***

Paragraph 14

And so we ask the Internet to keep interrupting us in ever more varied ways. We willingly accept the loss of concentration and focus, the fragmentation of our attention, and the thinning of our thoughts in return for the wealth of compelling, or at least **diverting**, information we receive. We rarely stop to think that it might actually make more sense just to tune it all out. ***(Show the situation that people willingly accept more information on the net rather than stop to think)***

Paragraph 15

The mental consequences of our online info-crunching are not universally bad. Certain cognitive skills are strengthened by our use of computers and the Net. These tend to involve more primitive mental functions, such as hand-eye coordination, **reflex** response, and the processing of visual cues. One much-cited study of videogaming, published in *Nature* in 2003, revealed that after just 10 days of playing action games on computers, a group of young people

had significantly boosted the speed with which they could shift their visual focus between various images and tasks. ***(State the benefits of the mental consequences brought by the online about the coordination and response)***

Paragraph 16

We know that the human brain is highly plastic; neurons and synapses change as circumstances change. When we adapt to a new cultural phenomenon, including the use of a new medium, we end up with a different brain, says Michael Merzenich, a pioneer of the field of neuroplasticity. That means our online habits continue to **reverberate** in the workings of our brain cells even when we're not at a computer. We're exercising the neural circuits devoted to **skimming** and multitasking while ignoring those used for reading and thinking deeply. ***(Show that our brain is plastic and the computer make our thinking more similar to it to reading quickly and not thinking deeply)***

Paragraph 17

Last year, researchers at Stanford found signs that this shift may already be well under way. They gave a battery of cognitive tests to a group of heavy media multitaskers as well as a group of relatively light ones. They discovered that the heavy multitaskers were much more easily distracted, had significantly less control over their working memory, and were generally much less able to concentrate on a task. Intensive multitaskers are "suckers for irrelevancy," says Clifford Nass, one professor who did the research. "Everything distracts them." Merzenich offers an even bleaker assessment: As we multitask online, we are "training our brains to pay attention to the **crap**." ***(Cite the researchers to utter that heavy media multitaskers are more easily distracted)***

Paragraph 18

There's nothing wrong with absorbing information quickly and in bits and pieces. We've always skimmed newspapers more than we've read them, and we routinely run our eyes over books and magazines to get the gist of a piece of writing and decide whether it **warrants** more thorough reading. The ability to scan and browse is as important as the ability to read deeply and think attentively. The problem is that skimming is becoming our dominant mode of thought. Once a means to an end, a way to identify information for further study, it's becoming an end in itself—our preferred method of both learning and analysis. Dazzled by the Net's treasures, we are blind to the damage we may be doing to our intellectual lives and even our culture. ***(Point out that the problem is not absorbing information quickly but that skimming becomes our dominant mode of thought)***

Paragraph 19

What we're experiencing is, in a **metaphorical** sense, a reversal of the early **trajectory** of civilization: We are evolving from cultivators of personal knowledge into hunters and gatherers in the electronic data forest. In the process, we seem fated to sacrifice much of what makes our minds so interesting. ***(End in the point of view in the whole humanity that we might evolve from cultivators into hunters and gatherers through abandoning some interesting properties in our mind)***

Significant Words and Phrases

- shatter **#CET6**
break into many pieces
- surmise
guess, consider
- cursory
superficial, narrow
- lockstep
a traditional and standard procedure
- navigate **#CET6**
make the path or direction clear; deal with
- entail **#CET6**
make something necessary
- calisthenics
gymnastic, a type of sports
- extraneous
exterior
- ubiquitous
common
- impede
disturb
- hinge on **#CET6**
depend on(hinge: key)
- thimble
a thin pipe
- faucet
tap
- drip **#CET4** **#CET6**
following in drops

- amplify #CET6
enlarge
 - juggle
trick
 - divert #CET6
turn away from
 - reverberate
reflect
 - skim #CET6
remove
 - crap
worthless things
 - warrant #CET6
necessary; sound reason
 - metaphorical #CET6
expressing one thing by expressing another
 - trajectory
path
-

Topic Idea

This article analyses the negative influence of difficult concentration of Web to reading, the approaches of thinking and the fate of humanity in mind step by step and expresses the regret of this situation.

Structure

Paragraph 1, as the introduction, introduces the claim that the web are gradually changing our structure of our brain in thinking.

From paragraph 2 to paragraph 18, as the body, the essay analyzes the research history of web to our brain, the essence of it and what the problem is step by step.

Paragraph 19, as the conclusion, the author promotes the essay from the influence of the structure of brains to the fate of humanity civilization.

Activity 5

ACTIVITY 5

Read the essay, critically considering its writing techniques, and discuss the following questions in groups.

1. What is the central claim Carr makes in this essay?
2. What are the reasons Carr provides to support his central claim? Please outline how he develops his reasoning.
3. What are the modes of reasoning used in Carr's argumentation? Are they effective? Why or why not?
4. Are you convinced by Carr's reasoning about the effect of the Web on our brains? Why or why not?
5. Examine the different kinds of evidence that Carr cites to support his claim. What might he have ignored? What are his possible assumptions? What sources might be cited in arguing against him?

1. The Web makes our thinking shallower and changing our structure of our brain and the approaches of thinking.
2. First, he recalled the history that people began to suspect the influence of the Web to brain. Then, he analyses the essence of the web interrupting our thinking by the facts and researches. At last, he points out what the true problem is.
3. Logos and ethos. They are effective since the essay logically analyzes the claim and cites many researches to convince the readers and meanwhile make it more credible and effective.

Activity 1

ACTIVITY I



Working individually or in pairs, examine the following statements and identify the types of logical fallacies in them.

1. My roommate said her statistics course was stressful, and the one I am in is stressful, too. All statistics classes must be stressful!
2. Using animal products such as fur and leather reduces our respect for life. If we do not respect life, we are likely to be more and more tolerant of violence. Before we know it, our society will become a jungle in which everyone constantly fears for their lives. It will be the end of civilization.
3. Guns are like hammers—they are both tools with metal parts that could be used to kill someone. And yet it would be ridiculous to restrict the purchase of hammers—so restrictions on purchasing guns are equally ridiculous.
4. Mother of a kindergarten pupil to his teacher: I am worried about my son's allergic sinusitis. Could you please make sure that you turn on the air purifier and keep the doors and windows closed on heavily polluted days in Beijing?
The teacher: Do not worry. There are so many kids in our class. Rest assured that we will take care of them.
5. This classroom building is in bad shape. Either we tear it down and put up a new building, or we continue to risk students' lives. Since we should not risk anyone's life, we must tear the building down.

1. Hasty generalization.
2. The "slippery-slope" fallacy.
3. Faulty analogy.
4. Non sequitur.
5. "Either/Or" fallacy.

From Diversity to Pluralism

The Pluralism Project, Harvard University

1. All of America's diversity, old and new, does not add up to pluralism. "Pluralism" and "diversity" are sometimes used as if they were **synonymous**, but diversity—splendid, colorful, and perhaps threatening—is not pluralism. Pluralism is the engagement that creates a common society from all that diversity. For example, on the same street in Silver Spring, Maryland are a Vietnamese Catholic church, a Cambodian Buddhist temple, a Ukrainian Orthodox church, a Muslim Community Center, a Hispanic First Church of God,

and a Hindu temple. This is certainly diversity, but without any engagement or relationship among the different groups it may not be an instance of pluralism. ***(Introduce that pluralism is not identical to diversity and take an example to interpret their difference to emphasize the pluralism)***

2. Pluralism is only one of the possible responses to this new diversity. Some people may feel threatened by diversity, or even hostile to it. Others may look forward to the day when all differences fade into the landscape of a predominantly Christian culture. For those who welcome the new diversity, creating a workable pluralism will mean engaging people of different faiths and cultures in the creation of a common society. Pluralism is not a “given,” but an achievement. ***(Show that pluralism is only one of the possible response to future diversity and different people have different views)***
3. From a historical perspective, the terms “exclusion,” “assimilation,” and “pluralism” suggest three different ways Americans have approached this widening cultural and religious diversity. The exclusionist answer to the tumultuous influx of cultural and religious diversity that seemed to threaten the very core of American civilization was to close the door, particularly to “aliens”—whether Asians, Catholics, or Jews. Assimilationists, like those who envisioned America as a “melting pot,” invited new immigrants to come, but to leave their differences and particularities behind as quickly as possible. The message was: come and be like us, come and conform to a predominantly Anglo-Protestant culture. For pluralists, like Horace Kallen in the early twentieth century, the American promise to immigrants was: come as you are, with all your differences and particularities, pledged only to the common civic demands of American citizenship. Come and be yourself, contributing in your distinctive way to the “orchestra” of American civilization. ***(State three different ways Americans confronts the widening cultural and religious diversity, that is, exclusionist argues for it is threat, assimilationist argues for "come in and become American" while pluralist argues for "come in and be yourself")***
4. Today’s discussion of America’s religious and cultural diversity echoes these voices of the past. America’s new religious diversity has produced fault lines, the cracks that indicate deep fractures and divisions. As experienced by immigrant Hindu, Buddhist, Sikh, or Muslim communities, stereotypes and prejudice have taken both old and new forms. There are encounters—at times hostile—over “zoning” and “traffic,” as new religious communities move into the neighborhood. Though often legitimate concerns, these also express fear and uncertainty about newcomers in the community. Unfortunately, incidents of vandalism, arson, and even physical violence have also sometimes been directed against these new religious centers and the communities that call them home. ***(Show that the religious and cultural diversity in no matter old or new forms all take stereotypes and prejudice to immigrants)***
5. But America’s religious diversity has also produced a new period of bridge-building, as diverse religious communities foster unprecedented relationships with one another. In Omaha, Nebraska Christians, Jews, and Muslims are building a “tri-faith” campus that will

include a church, a **synagogue**, a **mosque**, and an interfaith community center. Hindu temples and Sikh gurdwaras have gradually joined councils of churches, synagogues, and mosques. The interfaith infrastructure of America's cities and towns is strengthened with dialogues, **congregational** partnerships, coalitions to fight hunger and homelessness, and interfaith Thanksgiving services. On school boards, there are productive encounters over religion's proper role in the public schools. ***(State that the religious diversity also foster the relationship between different religious communities)***

6. Today, as in every era, Americans are appropriating anew the meaning of "We, the people of the United States of America..." What does "we" mean in a multi-religious America? How do "we" relate to one another, when that "we" includes Buddhist Americans, like the Hawaiian-born Buddhist astronaut who died on the Challenger, Muslim Americans, like a small town Texas mayor, and Sikh Americans, like a research scientist in Fairfax, Virginia? What exactly is pluralism? ***(Ask a sequence of problems about the meaning of the "we" in Americans' argument)***
7. First, pluralism is not the sheer fact of diversity alone, but is active engagement with that diversity. One can be an observer of diversity. One can "celebrate diversity," as the cliché goes. One can be critical of it or threatened by it. But real pluralism requires participation and engagement. Diversity can and often has meant isolation—the creation of virtual ghettos of religions and sub-cultures with little traffic between them. The dynamic of pluralism, however, is one of meeting, exchange, and two-way traffic. Kallen's analogy of the orchestra sounding together may be a good one, but as Kallen was well aware, the symphony remains unfinished. The music of America's cultures, perhaps more like jazz, depends upon having an ear always **attuned** to the genius of the other players. ***(Interpret that the pluralism is active engagement with diversity rather than isolation and loneliness)***
8. Second, pluralism is more than the mere tolerance of differences; it requires knowledge of them. Tolerance, while certainly important, may be a deceptive virtue by itself, perhaps even standing in the way of engagement. Tolerance does not require people to know anything about one another, and so can let us harbor all the stereotypes and half-truths we want to believe about our neighbors. Tolerance is definitely important, but it does little to remove our ignorance of one another. It is too thin a foundation for a society as religiously diverse and complex as America's. ***(Explain that pluralism is not just tolerance of differences but also the knowledge of them)***
9. Third, pluralism is not simply relativism, but makes room for real and different religious commitments. Some people are wary of the language of pluralism, insisting that it effectively waters down one's own religious beliefs by acknowledging that others believe differently. Some mistakenly think a pluralist perspective assumes that there are no differences among various religious traditions and their values. But actually, the encounter of a pluralist society is one of genuine commitments and real differences. Pluralism does not require **relinquishing** the distinctiveness of one's own tradition of faith to reach the "lowest common

denominator.” In the public square of a pluralist society, commitments are not left at the door, but invited in. People of every faith or of none can be themselves, with all their particularities, while engaging in the creation of a civil society. Pluralism is the process of creating a society through critical and self-critical encounter with one another, acknowledging, rather than hiding, our deepest differences. **(State that pluralism is not simply relativism and to see them as the same but makes room for real differences)**

10. Fourth, pluralism in America is clearly based on the common ground rules of the First Amendment to the Constitution: “no establishment” of religion and the “free exercise” of religion. The vigorous encounter of a pluralistic society is not premised on achieving agreement on matters of conscience and faith, but on achieving something far more valuable: the relationship of ongoing debate and discussion. *E Pluribus Unum*, “out of many, one,” envisions one people, a common sense of a civic “we,” but not one religion, one faith, or one conscience: *unum* does not mean uniformity. Perhaps the most valuable common bond people of many faiths have is their mutual commitment to a society based on the give and take of civil dialogue at a common table. **(Show that the pluralism does not argue for conscience but for harmonious relationship of ongoing debate and discussion)**
11. Fifth, pluralism requires the nurturing of constructive dialogue to reveal both common understandings and real differences. Not everyone at the “table” will agree with one another; the process of public dialogue will inevitably reveal areas of disagreement as well. Pluralism involves the commitment to be at the table—with one’s beliefs. Discovering where these “tables” are in American society and encouraging a climate conducive to dialogue is critically important for the flourishing of a civil society. **(State that pluralism requires publicly constructive dialogue to reveal both common understandings and real differences)**
12. So where are those public spaces, those “tables” where people of various traditions and beliefs meet in American society? In neighborhoods and community organizations, schools and colleges, legislatures and courts, zoning boards and planning commissions, interfaith councils and coalitions, chaplaincies and hospitals. In every one of these areas of public life, Americans are now facing new questions, new challenges, and new tensions in appropriating a more complex sense of who “we” now are. **(Answer the question that “Where are the public spaces for differences”--Everywhere Americans are facing new problems about who they are)**
13. One of the institutions where a new orientation toward pluralism has been most visible, and for some most controversial, is the Christian church. As the dominant religious tradition of America, the climate of Christian life and thought unquestionably contributes to both the stunting and nurturing of pluralism. No doubt, the late twentieth and early twenty-first centuries have seen the resurgence of a strong exclusivist Christianity in some churches, some to the point of attacking other traditions. This was the case in 2010 when a Florida pastor made international news by threatening to burn a Qur’an to mark the tenth

anniversary of 9/11, an action he carried out in 2011 and 2012. **(Emphasize the prominence of the attitude for Christian life to the pluralism)**

14. But there has also been a concurrent re-examination of the relation of Christianity to other world religions that has been strong, positive, and **biblically**-based. The Roman Catholic Church and most of the major Protestant denominations have given new emphasis to interfaith dialogue as essential to the relation of Christians to people of other faiths. Documents like the Catholic *Nostra Aetate*, the Presbyterian “Interfaith Relations Denominational Principles and Policies,” and the United Methodist “Guidelines for Interreligious Partnerships” provide a new sense of direction for Christians seeking to be good neighbors in a multi-religious society. Meanwhile, the National Council of Churches’ Interfaith Relations initiative works with member churches, Protestant and **Orthodox**, as well as with Catholic partners to support interfaith understanding and action. Such emphasis on engagement with Muslims, Jews, Buddhists, Hindus, and others has created among many Christians a climate of commitment to a **vibrant** and productive pluralism. **(State that the relation of Christianity to other religions has been strong and positive and contributes to pluralism)**
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Significant Words and Phrases

- synonymous
tightly related
- assimilation **#CET6**
absorption
- tumultuous
disordered
- influx
invasion
- fracture **#CET6**
break, crack
- legitimate **#CET6**
make legal; legal
- unprecedented **#CET6**
have no examples before
- synagogue
the place of worship for Jews
- mosque
the place of worship for Muslim

- congregational #CET6
gathered
 - attune
make harmonious
 - nurture #CET6
cultivate
 - stunt
disturb
 - resurgence
make flourishing again
 - pastor
a career in church
 - biblical
related to Bible
 - orthodox #CET6
traditional
 - vibrant
vigorous
 - relinquishing
abandon
-

Topic Idea

This essay introduces in detail the differences between pluralism and diversity and explain the accurate meaning of pluralism and argues for the future of pluralism.

Structure

Paragraph 1, as the introduction, introduces that pluralism is not identical to diversity and explains the claim about pluralism.

From paragraph 2 to 12, as the body, the essay explains in detail about the meaning of pluralism.

From paragraph 13 to 14, as the conclusion, the essay states the prominence of Christianity to the pluralism.

Activity 6

Read the essay critically for its ideas and discuss the following questions in pairs.

1. According to the author, what is the difference between diversity and pluralism?
2. In Paragraph 3, what does the author mean by “Come and be yourself, contributing in your distinctive way to the ‘orchestra’ of American civilization”?
3. According to the author, “From a historical perspective, the terms ‘exclusion,’ ‘assimilation,’ and ‘pluralism’ suggest three different ways Americans have approached this widening cultural and religious diversity.” (Para. 3) Categorize “melting pot” and “salad bowl” mentioned in the Issue Prompt to see whether they fall into one of the three ways and explain why.
4. “Pluralism does not require relinquishing the distinctiveness of one’s own tradition of faith to reach the ‘lowest common denominator.’”(Para. 9) What does the “lowest common denominator” probably mean?

5. In the Issue Prompt, “cultural pluralism” is put in the parentheses after multiculturalism, indicating that it is a synonym. Examine the definition of multiculturalism carefully. Is it the same as “pluralism” in this essay?

1. Diversity is statistic, isolated and ignores or hides the differences while the pluralism is active engagement with diversity and has a knowledge of different.
2. Every culture can come into America and maintain their own features to construct the American civilization.
3. "Melting pot" is assimilation since it means different things come into the pot and become the same item while "salad bowl" is pluralism since it maintains the differences between different cultures.
4. Force the distinctive culture to relinquish their particularity to achieve the common diversity.
5. Multiculturalism argues that several different cultures can coexist peacefully and equitably in a single country. It is not the same as "pluralism" in this essay since this essay focus on America and especially in the religious field.